

— THE — WEALTHY FOUNDATION ◇ WORKBOOK

A Practical Companion for Building
Financial Stability, Direction, and Freedom



See clearly. Find the pressure. Choose the next right move.

— MARK A. WILLIAMS —

THE WEALTHY FOUNDATION WORKBOOK

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This workbook is for general educational and informational purposes only. It does not provide financial, investment, tax, legal, insurance, or accounting advice. Before making financial decisions, consider your own circumstances and consult qualified professionals where appropriate.

This workbook is designed to help you think more clearly about your financial life. It is not a substitute for professional advice, and it does not guarantee any specific financial result.

WELCOME

This workbook is not about proving that you are good or bad with money. It is not about shame. It is not about perfection. It is about seeing clearly.

In A Wealthy Foundation, Ryan Cole begins with a familiar kind of pressure. He has a decent income. He pays his bills. He is trying to do the responsible thing. But somehow, ordinary life keeps pushing him backward. His paycheck feels like it already belongs somewhere else before it arrives.

Ryan's story may not match yours exactly. Your income, debt, age, family, job, goals, and responsibilities may be different. But the pressure underneath may feel familiar.

This workbook helps you slow down, look honestly at the structure underneath your financial life, and choose the next right move.

PRIVATE BY DEFAULT

You are the only one seeing what you write here unless you choose to share it. There is no reason to perform, hide, or make the numbers look better than they are.

If you have debt, write it down. If you feel behind, write it down. If you are unsure where your money is going, write it down. If you are doing better in some areas than you realized, write that down too.

Honesty is not failure. Honesty is where building begins.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

You do not have to finish this workbook in one sitting. In fact, you probably should not.

- Print it and write directly on the pages.
- Use a pencil if that makes it easier to be honest.
- Skip a section that does not apply right now.
- Come back to difficult pages later.
- Circle questions that make you uncomfortable.
- Write “I don’t know yet” when that is the honest answer.

The goal is not to create a perfect financial plan by the end of the workbook. The goal is to see your financial life more clearly than you did when you started.

As you work through the pages, look for patterns: what keeps repeating, where the pressure shows up, which payments are claiming future income, what gives peace, and which building block needs support first.

FREE TO DOWNLOAD AGAIN

This workbook is free to download at AWealthyFoundation.com. Come back in six months or a year and work through a fresh copy. That is not starting over. That is continuing to build.

BOOK, WORKBOOK, AND WEBSITE

Piece	Purpose
Book	The story and framework. Ryan’s journey helps you see the pressure, patterns, temptations, and seven building blocks.
Workbook	The hands-on application. This is where you write things down, review real numbers, and choose your next right move.
Website	The interactive companion. Use AWealthyFoundation.com for the Foundation Score, Dashboard, calculators, reports, and continued growth.

You do not need the website to use this workbook. Every website reference is optional and helpful, not required.

PART ONE: START WITH CLARITY

Before you change anything, look. Most people want to start with action because pressure makes movement feel urgent. But movement is not always progress.

CORE IDEA

The first step is clarity, not perfection.

Start With Your Foundation Score

Visit [AWealthyFoundation.com](https://awealthyfoundation.com) and take the free Foundation assessment. Your score is not a grade on your worth. It is there to help you see where your foundation is strong and where it may need support.

FOUNDATION SCORE WORKSHEET

Date completed: _____

Foundation Score: _____

Strongest building block: _____

Weakest building block: _____

Current life stage: _____

My first reaction to my score was: _____

One thing that surprised me: _____

One thing I already knew but may have been avoiding: _____

One area I feel encouraged by: _____

One area I want to understand better: _____

REMINDER

Your score is a starting point, not a sentence. The number matters less than what it helps you notice.

QUICK FOUNDATION SNAPSHOT

Circle or mark the number that feels most honest. 1 = Not true right now. 5 = Very true.

Area	Statement	1 2 3 4 5
Breathing Room	I have room between my income and my obligations.	1 2 3 4 5
Spending	I know where most of my money actually goes each month.	1 2 3 4 5
Saving	I could handle an ordinary emergency without using new debt.	1 2 3 4 5
Debt	My monthly payments feel manageable.	1 2 3 4 5
Investing	I am investing consistently, even if the amount is small.	1 2 3 4 5
Protection	My insurance, beneficiaries, documents, and basic protection are in order.	1 2 3 4 5
Vision	I know what I am building toward.	1 2 3 4 5
Overall	My financial life feels steady.	1 2 3 4 5

QUICK FOUNDATION SNAPSHOT: WHAT I NOTICE

The area that feels strongest right now is: _____

The area that feels weakest right now is: _____

The area I avoid thinking about most is: _____

The area that would give me the most peace if it improved is: _____

The first thing this snapshot tells me is: _____

REMINDER

The goal is not to score yourself perfectly. The goal is to notice where the pressure may be coming from.

WHERE IS THE PRESSURE COMING FROM?

Financial pressure is not always caused by one bad decision. Sometimes it comes from a structure that has slowly become too tight.

The loudest financial problem in my life right now is: _____

The pressure that keeps repeating is: _____

The bill, loan, or payment I keep working around is: _____

One thing I have accepted as normal that may not actually be helping me is:

The area where I have the least breathing room is: _____

The financial topic I avoid most often is: _____

One thing I wish felt calmer is: _____

Based on what I can see right now, the pressure may be coming from: _____

PART TWO: THE THREE-MONTH CHECKUP

Most people do not have a clear picture of their financial life. They have a feeling. Feelings matter, but feelings do not always show the pattern.

Memory smooths things over. It forgets small purchases, explains away repeated “one-time” expenses, and remembers the month the way we hoped it happened.

Three months is long enough to reveal patterns, but short enough that the work is manageable.

NO SHAME

The Three-Month Checkup is not about punishing yourself. You are gathering information, not evidence against yourself.

GATHER THE LAST THREE MONTHS

Month 1: _____

Month 2: _____

Month 3: _____

Gather these if they apply

☐ Checking account statements

☐ Credit card statements

☐ Savings account activity

☐ Loan payment history

☐ Car loan or lease payments

☐ Student loan payments

☐ Buy Now Pay Later payments

☐ Personal loan payments

☐ Medical bills or payment plans

☐ Cash App, Venmo, PayPal, or similar activity

☐ Automatic subscriptions

☐ Insurance payments

☐ Utility bills

☐ Childcare or family support payments

☐ Large irregular expenses

☐ Other

THREE-MONTH REVIEW SETUP

Before I start, I expect to find: _____

I am most nervous to look at: _____

I am most curious to understand: _____

WHAT REPEATS EVERY MONTH?

Some expenses are obvious because they show up every month. Others hide because they are small, scattered, or automatic.

Category	Monthly Amount	Notes
Rent or mortgage	\$ _____	_____
Utilities	\$ _____	_____
Phone	\$ _____	_____
Internet	\$ _____	_____
Car payment	\$ _____	_____
Car insurance	\$ _____	_____
Gas/fuel	\$ _____	_____
Student loans	\$ _____	_____
Credit card minimums	\$ _____	_____
Personal loans	\$ _____	_____
Medical payment plans	\$ _____	_____
BNPL payments	\$ _____	_____
Childcare	\$ _____	_____
Family support	\$ _____	_____

MONTHLY REPEATING EXPENSES CONTINUED

Category	Monthly Amount	Notes
Groceries	\$ _____	_____
Eating out	\$ _____	_____
Subscriptions	\$ _____	_____
Giving	\$ _____	_____
Savings transfers	\$ _____	_____
Investing contributions	\$ _____	_____
Health/medical	\$ _____	_____
Pets	\$ _____	_____
School/activities	\$ _____	_____
Other	\$ _____	_____
Other	\$ _____	_____
Other	\$ _____	_____

Total repeating monthly expenses: \$ _____

FIXED OBLIGATIONS

Fixed obligations usually arrive whether the month is good or bad. They reduce flexibility before normal spending begins.

Obligation	Monthly Amount
Rent or mortgage	\$ _____
Car payment	\$ _____
Student loan payment	\$ _____
Credit card minimums	\$ _____
Personal loan payments	\$ _____
Medical payment plans	\$ _____
Insurance	\$ _____
Utilities	\$ _____
Phone/internet	\$ _____
Childcare/support obligations	\$ _____
Subscriptions/contracts	\$ _____
Other	\$ _____
Other	\$ _____

FIXED OBLIGATIONS CALCULATION

Total fixed monthly obligations: \$ _____

Monthly take-home income: \$ _____

Income left after fixed obligations: \$ _____

Percentage of take-home income committed to fixed obligations: _____

FORMULA

Total fixed obligations ÷ monthly take-home income = fixed obligation percentage.

What this tells me: _____

Where the structure feels tight: _____

One fixed obligation I may need to review: _____

WHAT SURPRISED YOU?

Look through the last three months and notice what you did not expect. Do not explain it away yet. Just notice.

I spent more than I expected on: _____

I forgot about: _____

This cost more than I thought: _____

This showed up more than once: _____

This felt worth it: _____

This did not feel worth it afterward: _____

One thing I learned from looking instead of guessing: _____

WHAT DID YOU CALL “ONE-TIME”?

Some expenses really are one-time. Others only feel that way because they do not repeat in the exact same form. The pattern may simply be: life keeps happening.

Expense	Month	Amount	Truly one-time?	Pattern underneath
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____

ONE-TIME EXPENSE REVIEW CONTINUED

One thing I keep treating as random that may actually need a plan is: _____

A small monthly amount I could set aside for this type of expense is: _____

Where I could keep that money: _____

The next predictable surprise I want to prepare for is: _____

REMINDER

A predictable surprise is not really a surprise anymore. Give that expense a place to land.

WHAT IS DEBT SMOOTHING OVER?

Debt often begins as a solution. The question is whether it is solving a one-time problem or covering a pattern that needs to be seen.

I used a credit card because: _____

I used financing or payment plans because: _____

I delayed paying something because: _____

I moved money from savings because: _____

I borrowed from future income because: _____

What I notice about my use of debt: _____

DEBT SMOOTHING OVER: UNDERLYING PRESSURE

The real pressure underneath may have been:

☐ Not enough emergency savings

☐ Spending by status

☐ Income timing problem

☐ Medical or family need

☐ Monthly obligations too high

☐ Major decision pressure

☐ Spending by habit

☐ Avoidance

☐ Spending by convenience

☐ Something else

☐ Spending by pressure

If debt is repeatedly covering the same shortage, the structure underneath may be:

One change that might reduce the need for debt is: _____

WHERE IS THE PAYCHECK ALREADY SPOKEN FOR?

Monthly take-home income: \$ _____

Fixed obligations: \$ _____

Minimum debt payments: \$ _____

Average groceries/household spending: \$ _____

Average transportation costs besides car payment: \$ _____

Average eating out/convenience spending: \$ _____

Average subscriptions/memberships: \$ _____

Average family/child/household obligations: \$ _____

Average savings/investing transfers: \$ _____

Other regular spending: \$ _____

Estimated remaining margin: \$ _____

PAYCHECK ALREADY SPOKEN FOR: REFLECTION

Does payday feel like money arriving, or money passing through? _____

Which bill or payment claims the paycheck first in my mind? _____

Which obligation would create the most breathing room if it disappeared?

What future income have I already promised away? _____

What do I want to change about how payday feels? _____

WHAT GIVES PEACE?

Not every expense is a problem. Some spending supports the life you actually want. Notice what is worth protecting.

This expense made life stronger: _____

This habit reduced stress in a healthy way: _____

This helped my family, home, health, work, or future: _____

This supported the life I actually want: _____

This is something I do not want to cut without a good reason: _____

WHAT ONLY HELPS ME LOOK SUCCESSFUL?

Some spending helps your life. Some spending only helps your life look a certain way from the outside.

This expense looked good from the outside but added pressure: _____

This purchase was more about image than value: _____

This subscription, habit, upgrade, or commitment does not really serve me anymore:

This decision helped me feel caught up, but did not help me get ahead:

If nobody else could see this decision, I might choose: _____

YOUR THREE-MONTH PATTERN

My biggest repeating pressure is: _____

My biggest money leak is: _____

My most fragile area is: _____

My strongest habit is: _____

One thing I need to stop pretending is random: _____

One thing that gives me peace and is worth protecting: _____

One thing that only helps me look successful: _____

One payment or obligation that is creating pressure: _____

One move that would create breathing room quickly: _____

My first next right move might be: _____

THREE-MONTH CHECKPOINT

What did I learn from the Three-Month Checkup? _____

What was harder to look at than I expected? _____

What was better than I expected? _____

What do I feel more clear about now? _____

What do I want to remember as I keep building? _____

PART THREE: THE SEVEN BUILDING BLOCKS

A strong financial life is not built from one number: not income alone, not a credit score, not a retirement balance, not a paid-off debt, and not one good habit.

A strong foundation is built from several parts working together: Income, Spending, Saving, Investing, Debt, Protection, and Vision.

BETTER QUESTION

Which block, if strengthened, would create the most breathing room in my life right now?

THE WHOLE FOUNDATION

Block	Meaning
Income	Money coming into your life through work, business, benefits, support, or other sources.
Spending	How money leaves through choices, habits, obligations, needs, pressure, convenience, and priorities.
Saving	Breathing room so ordinary problems do not automatically become emergencies.
Investing	Slow growth through consistency and time.
Debt	Future income already promised away.
Protection	The roof: insurance, documents, emergency planning, beneficiaries, and access plans.
Vision	The reason you are building.

The building block that feels strongest right now is: _____

The building block that feels weakest right now is: _____

The block creating the most pressure right now is: _____

The block I have avoided looking at is: _____

The block that would give me the most peace if it improved is: _____

INCOME: ONE MORE DOORWAY

Income is the money coming into your life. For many people, most income comes through one main doorway: a job, paycheck, business, retirement income, benefits, or household support.

There is nothing wrong with one main doorway. But when one doorway carries every bill, emergency, goal, debt payment, and future plan, the pressure can become heavy.

One more doorway does not have to be impressive. It has to be useful. A small second income source may only cover one bill at first, but one bill is not nothing.

GOAL

The goal is not hustle for the sake of hustle. The goal is margin.

MY CURRENT INCOME

My main income source is: _____

Monthly take-home income from this source: \$ _____

How reliable does this income feel?

☐ Very reliable

☐ Mostly reliable

☐ Somewhat reliable

☐ Unstable

☐ I am not sure

What makes this income reliable or unreliable: _____

Other income source	Monthly Amount	Reliable?	Notes
_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____
_____	\$ _____	Yes / No / Maybe	_____

Total monthly income from all sources: \$ _____

INCOME DOORWAY WORKSHEET

What do people already pay me to do? _____

What do people ask me for help with? _____

What skills do I already have? _____

What skills could I strengthen over the next year? _____

What problems do I know how to solve? _____

What tools, equipment, knowledge, or experience do I already have? _____

WHAT COULD EXTRA INCOME COVER?

My main income doorway is: _____

A possible second doorway is: _____

This could realistically earn each month: \$ _____

This could help cover: _____

First small step to test this idea: _____

\$100 per month could help with: _____

\$250 per month could help with: _____

\$500 per month could help with: _____

SPENDING: NORMAL VS. INTENTIONAL

Spending is not just where money goes. Spending is where direction shows up. Some spending supports the life you want. Other spending happens by habit, pressure, convenience, comparison, boredom, avoidance, or status.

CORE QUESTION

Is this normal, or is this intentional? Normal means you accepted it because everyone around you seems to accept it. Intentional means you chose it because it supports the life you are actually trying to build.

SPENDING CATEGORIES

Look back at your Three-Month Checkup and list examples in each category.

Spending by habit: _____

Spending by convenience: _____

Spending by pressure: _____

Spending by status: _____

Spending that supports the life I want: _____

Spending that only helps me look successful: _____

What have I accepted as normal that is not helping me build the life I want?

SPENDING RESET

One spending habit I want to reduce: _____

One expense I want to keep because it supports my life: _____

One expense I need to question: _____

One boundary I need to set: _____

Money I could redirect each month: \$ _____

Where I will redirect it

☐ Emergency savings

☐ Major decision fund

☐ Debt payoff

☐ Giving

☐ Investing

☐ Other

☐ Protection/insurance/documents

My first spending reset move: _____

SAVING: BREATHING ROOM

Saving is not punishment. Saving is breathing room. It is the space between ordinary life and financial emergency.

The first savings goal does not have to be perfect. Start with the amount that would make you feel less fragile: \$250, \$500, \$1,000, one month of rent, one month of expenses, or one full paycheck.

PURPOSE

The first job of savings is not to impress you. The first job of savings is to protect your next ordinary problem from becoming debt.

MY SAVING PICTURE

Current emergency savings: \$ _____

Where this money is kept: _____

Is it too easy to raid?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Maybe

An ordinary problem that would currently become an emergency for me:

The amount that would make me feel less fragile is: _____

Why that amount would help: _____

A first savings target I can work toward is: _____

MY BREATHING ROOM PLAN

Where I will keep my breathing room money: _____

How I will make it available but not too easy to raid: _____

What this money is for: _____

What this money is not for: _____

Amount I will transfer: \$ _____

How often?

☐ Weekly

☐ Every paycheck

☐ Monthly

☐ Other

Transfer date or timing: _____

First target date: _____

First savings target: \$ _____

INVESTING: SLOW GROWTH

Investing is not the same as chasing speed. Chasing speed asks, “How fast can this make me look successful?” Investing asks, “What can consistency and time build if I give them room to work?”

For many people, the first useful step is simply knowing what accounts they have, where they are, how much is going into them, and whether the plan still makes sense.

If you have had several jobs, you may have old retirement accounts scattered around. This section is about gathering the pieces before making changes.

MY INVESTING PICTURE

Am I currently investing?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ I am not sure

Where am I currently investing?

☐ 401(k) or workplace retirement plan

☐ HSA

☐ Roth IRA

☐ Pension

☐ Traditional IRA

☐ Other

☐ Brokerage account

☐ I do not know yet

Current monthly contribution amount, if known: \$ _____

Current contribution percentage, if known: _____

Does my employer offer a match?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ I do not know

Am I investing to build, or to prove something? _____

What do I control? _____

What do I not control? _____

INVESTMENT ACCOUNT CHECKUP

Use this page to gather your accounts in one place. You may need to search old emails, contact previous employers, log into retirement websites, or call plan providers.

Account Type	Employer/Provider	Login Known?	Approx. Balance	Contrib.?	Beneficiary?	Follow-Up?
Current 401(k)	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Old 401(k)	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Old 401(k)	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Roth IRA	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Traditional IRA	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No

INVESTMENT ACCOUNT INVENTORY CONTINUED

Account Type	Employer/Provider	Login Known?	Approx. Balance	Contrib.?	Beneficiary?	Follow-Up?
Brokerage	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
HSA	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Pension	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Other	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No
Other	_____	Yes / No	\$_____	Yes / No	Yes / No / Unsure	Yes / No

Accounts I need to track down: _____

Previous employers I may need to contact: _____

Questions I need answered: _____

RETIREMENT PLAN REVIEW

Set aside time to log into your current 401(k), retirement plan, IRA, or benefits website. If you are not sure where to start, contact HR or the plan provider.

- ☐ Log into my current workplace retirement plan
- ☐ Confirm my contribution percentage
- ☐ Confirm whether my employer offers a match
- ☐ Check whether I am receiving the full available match
- ☐ Review my current investment choices
- ☐ Review fees if available
- ☐ Confirm my beneficiary information
- ☐ Look for old retirement accounts from previous jobs
- ☐ Decide whether any stray accounts may need rollover/consolidation review
- ☐ Write down questions for HR, the plan provider, or a qualified professional

My current contribution is: _____

My employer match is: _____

One thing I may want to change or understand better: _____

One account I may need to roll over or consolidate: _____

DASHBOARD CHECK-IN

If you use AWealthyFoundation.com, update your investing information or retake your Foundation Score after completing this section.

DEBT: FUTURE INCOME ALREADY PROMISED

Debt can feel like a number from the past, but payments reach forward. A balance may have started years ago, but the payment still claims part of your next paycheck.

For some people, this may be the first time every debt has been written down in one place. You are not doing this to shame yourself. You are doing it because debt becomes less mysterious when it is visible.

TRUTH ON PAPER

An honest number is easier to carry than a hidden one.

DEBT REFLECTION

The debt I think about most often is: _____

The payment creating the most pressure is: _____

The debt I avoid looking at is: _____

The debt that helped solve a real problem was: _____

The debt that may be covering a structural shortfall is: _____

One debt I most want gone is: _____

DEBT INVENTORY

Write down every debt: credit cards, car loans, student loans, personal loans, medical debt, Buy Now Pay Later balances, family loans, old collections, and anything else you owe.

Debt Name	Type	Balance	Interest	Minimum	Time Left	Notes
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____

DEBT INVENTORY CONTINUED

Debt Name	Type	Balance	Interest	Minimum	Time Left	Notes
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	_____	_____

Total debt: \$ _____

Total minimum monthly payments: \$ _____

Debt with the highest interest rate: _____

Debt with the payment creating the most monthly pressure: _____

MY FREEDOM DATE

Debt can feel endless when you only see the monthly payment. A freedom date helps you see the timeline.

Debt-free date if I pay only the minimums: _____

Debt-free date if I add extra payments: _____

Extra monthly amount I could realistically add: _____

Debt I would attack first: _____

Why this debt matters to me: _____

What would become possible when this payment is gone? _____

ONLINE COMPANION TOOL

Use the My Freedom Date Calculator at AWealthyFoundation.com to see how your debt-free date changes when you add extra payments, reduce payments, or keep paying only the minimums.

CAR PAYMENT OPPORTUNITY COST

A car payment can feel normal because so many people have one. But normal is not the same as harmless.

Vehicle: _____

Monthly payment: \$ _____

Months remaining: _____

Total remaining payments: \$ _____

Monthly insurance cost: \$ _____

Estimated monthly fuel cost: \$ _____

Estimated maintenance/repair cost: \$ _____

This payment makes it harder to:

☐ Save

☐ Invest

☐ Pay off debt

☐ Build emergency savings

☐ Give

☐ Change jobs

☐ Handle repairs

☐ Move

☐ Start a business

☐ Sleep well

☐ Other

ONLINE COMPANION TOOL

Use the Car Payment Opportunity Cost Calculator at AWealthyFoundation.com before finishing this section.

DEBT PRESSURE REVIEW

The payment creating the most pressure is: _____

The debt I most want gone is: _____

The debt with the highest interest rate is: _____

The debt that would create the most breathing room if removed is: _____

The debt I need to stop adding to is: _____

The habit or structure feeding this debt is: _____

My First Debt Move

☐ Stop adding new charges to one account

☐ Pay extra on one debt

☐ Build small emergency savings first

☐ Sell something and apply the money

☐ Use extra income toward debt

☐ Call lender or servicer

☐ Review student loan options

☐ Use My Freedom Date Calculator

☐ Use Car Payment Opportunity Cost Calculator

☐ Other

My first debt move is: _____

PROTECTION: THE ROOF

Protection is the roof over your financial foundation. It helps keep one bad day from undoing years of progress. Protection includes insurance, emergency savings, beneficiaries, documents, access plans, and the basic preparation that helps your future self and your loved ones know what to do.

PURPOSE

This section is not meant to scare you. It is meant to help you prepare with kindness.

PROTECTION CHECKUP

- ☐ Emergency savings

☐ Health insurance

☐ Auto insurance

☐ Renters insurance

☐ Homeowners insurance

☐ Disability coverage

☐ Life insurance, if someone depends on my income

☐ Updated beneficiaries
- ☐ Emergency contacts

☐ Will

☐ Trust, if applicable

☐ Power of attorney

☐ Healthcare directive or similar document

☐ Password/access plan

☐ Important documents gathered

☐ Trusted people know where important information is located

One event that would create major pressure right now is: _____

The protection gap I am most concerned about is: _____

One thing I have been avoiding is: _____

One thing I could handle better than I realized is: _____

THE PROTECTION FOLDER

Create one folder, binder, or lockbox that gathers important information in one place. Trusted people do not necessarily need copies of passwords or keys, but at least two people should know where this folder is and how it can be accessed if something happens.

Category	Items to gather
Legal	Will, trust documents if applicable, power of attorney, healthcare directive.
Insurance	Life, health, auto, homeowners/renters, disability policies.
Medical / Emergency	Emergency contacts, doctor list, medication list, medical wishes.
Financial	Bank accounts, retirement accounts, debts/lenders, tax records or location notes.
Property / Identity	Vehicle titles, property documents, passports, birth certificates, Social Security cards or location notes.
Access / Household	Password manager instructions, key locations, household instructions, final wishes if desired.

Location of my Protection Folder or lockbox: _____

Trusted person 1: _____

Trusted person 2: _____

PROTECTION FOLLOW-UP

One document I need to find or create: _____

One beneficiary I need to confirm or update: _____

One insurance policy I need to review: _____

One account or password access issue I need to address: _____

One person who should know where my important documents are: _____

One professional I may need to contact: _____

My first protection step: _____

I will complete this by: _____

VISION: WHAT ARE YOU BUILDING?

Vision is the reason behind the work. Without vision, financial improvement can become nothing more than cutting, tracking, paying, saving, and grinding.

Money should serve something: peace, stability, family, freedom, generosity, health, options, time, work you can choose, a home that feels steady, or a future that does not depend on panic.

CORE IDEA

Vision does not have to impress anyone. It only has to be honest.

VISION QUESTIONS

What do I want money to do in my life? _____

What do I not want money to cost me? _____

What am I unwilling to trade away? _____

What does enough look like for me? _____

What would make my life stronger, not just more impressive? _____

Who benefits if I build a stronger foundation? _____

What kind of future self am I trying to help? _____

QUESTIONS ONLY I CAN ANSWER

Vision may mean something different for every reader. Use this page to write your own questions. If the question matters to your future, it belongs here.

Question 1: _____

My honest answer: _____

Question 2: _____

My honest answer: _____

Question 3: _____

My honest answer: _____

Question 4: _____

My honest answer: _____

SEVEN BUILDING BLOCKS SUMMARY

My strongest block is: _____

Why this block is strong: _____

My weakest block is: _____

Why this block needs attention: _____

The block creating the most pressure is: _____

How that pressure shows up: _____

The block that would create the most breathing room if strengthened is:

Why this one matters now: _____

My next right move from this section is: _____

PART FOUR: BEFORE YOU SIGN

Some financial decisions are small enough to correct quickly. Others follow you for years: college, cars, and houses. These decisions are not wrong by themselves. The danger is that people often make them before they understand what the decision will require from future income, future margin, future flexibility, and future peace.

CORE QUESTION

What does this require from my future self? Approval is not the same as wisdom.

MAJOR DECISIONS AND YOUR FUTURE SELF

Use this page before any decision large enough to shape the next several years of your life.

The decision I am considering is: _____

Why I am considering it: _____

The part of this decision that excites me: _____

The part of this decision that concerns me: _____

What does this require from my future self? _____

FUTURE SELF QUESTIONS

What future income am I promising away? _____

How long will this decision follow me? _____

What monthly payment or recurring cost does this create? _____

What costs are not included in the advertised price or monthly payment?

What assumptions have to be true for this to work? _____

What pressure does this add? _____

What flexibility does this remove? _____

Which building blocks are affected?

☐ Income

☐ Saving

☐ Debt

☐ Vision

☐ Spending

☐ Investing

☐ Protection

Can my foundation carry this decision right now?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Maybe

☐ I need more information

COLLEGE DECISION WORKSHEET

College can be a doorway. It can also create years of pressure if the cost, debt, career path, and likely income are not considered honestly.

School/program I am considering: _____

Degree, certificate, or training path: _____

Why I am considering this path: _____

Tuition and fees per year: \$ _____

Room and board, if applicable: \$ _____

Books, supplies, equipment, and technology: \$ _____

Transportation: \$ _____

Other estimated costs: \$ _____

Total estimated cost per year: \$ _____

Total estimated cost for the full program: \$ _____

COLLEGE COST AND FUNDING

Scholarships or grants: \$ _____

Savings or family contribution: \$ _____

Income from working while in school: \$ _____

Student loans needed: \$ _____

Estimated monthly student loan payment after graduation: \$ _____

How many years could this debt follow me: _____

Career path this may support: _____

Realistic starting income range: \$ _____

Long-term income potential: _____

Is this degree or training required for the work I want?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Maybe

☐ I am not sure

COLLEGE FUTURE SELF REVIEW

- ☐ Could I start at a community college?
- ☐ Could I work while completing this?
- ☐ Could I live at home or reduce housing costs?
- ☐ Could I choose a less expensive school or program?
- ☐ Could an employer help pay for this?

Lower-cost options I should compare: _____

What does this require from my future self? _____

What assumptions have to be true for this to work? _____

What pressure could this add after graduation? _____

What opportunity could this create? _____

If I choose this path, am I choosing it with clear eyes? _____

CAR DECISION WORKSHEET

A vehicle is often necessary. But the payment is not only transportation. It is future income assigned ahead of time.

Vehicle I am considering: _____

Reason for buying or changing vehicles: _____

Is this need, comfort, pressure, status, or a mix? _____

Purchase price: \$ _____

Down payment: \$ _____

Amount financed: \$ _____

Interest rate: _____

Loan length: _____

Monthly payment: \$ _____

Total of all payments over the loan: \$ _____

VEHICLE COST AND FOUNDATION IMPACT

Insurance estimate per month: \$ _____

Fuel estimate per month: \$ _____

Maintenance/repairs estimate per month: \$ _____

Registration/taxes/fees: \$ _____

Tires or expected upcoming repairs: \$ _____

Total estimated monthly vehicle cost: \$ _____

This vehicle payment would make it harder to:

☐ Save

☐ Invest

☐ Pay off debt

☐ Build emergency savings

☐ Handle repairs

☐ Give

☐ Change jobs

☐ Move

☐ Start a business

☐ Sleep well

☐ Other

CAR ALTERNATIVES AND FINAL QUESTION

What future income am I promising away: _____

☐ Could I repair my current vehicle?

☐ Could I buy less vehicle?

☐ Could I wait and save more first?

☐ Could I choose a shorter loan term?

☐ Could I avoid starting a new payment cycle?

Alternatives I should compare: _____

What would an intentional version of this decision look like? _____

Does this vehicle strengthen my life, or stretch my foundation? _____

ONLINE COMPANION TOOL

Use the Car Payment Opportunity Cost Calculator at AWealthyFoundation.com before making a final decision.

HOUSE DECISION WORKSHEET

A house can be a blessing. But a house can also create pressure that does not show up in the mortgage approval.

Home I am considering: _____

Reason I want to buy this home: _____

What I hope this home provides: _____

Home price: \$ _____

Down payment: \$ _____

Estimated closing costs: \$ _____

Moving costs: \$ _____

Immediate repairs or updates needed: \$ _____

Furniture/appliances/tools needed: \$ _____

HOUSE COSTS AND STRESS TEST

Mortgage payment: \$ _____

Property taxes per month: \$ _____

Homeowners insurance per month: \$ _____

Mortgage insurance, if applicable: \$ _____

HOA fees, if applicable: \$ _____

Utilities estimate: \$ _____

Maintenance/repair savings: \$ _____

Total estimated monthly housing cost: \$ _____

What happens if income drops? _____

What happens if expenses rise? _____

What happens if a major repair is needed in the first year? _____

What happens if taxes or insurance increase? _____

HOUSE FOUNDATION IMPACT AND VISION CHECK

This house would affect my:

- ☐ Income
- ☐ Saving
- ☐ Debt
- ☐ Vision
- ☐ Spending
- ☐ Investing
- ☐ Protection

What flexibility does this remove? _____

What stability does this create? _____

What pressure does this add? _____

Does this home support the life I am building? _____

Am I buying stability, or pressure that looks like progress? _____

Can my foundation carry this house? _____

CREDIT CARDS AND PAYMENT PLANS

College, cars, and houses are often the big decisions. But credit cards, payment plans, store financing, personal loans, and Buy Now Pay Later offers can quietly follow those decisions around.

Before you use credit to make a decision work, ask whether the decision actually works.

What am I about to put on credit or finance? _____

Why am I using credit instead of cash? _____

Is this solving a one-time problem or covering a repeating shortage? _____

What will the payment be? _____

How long will it take to pay off? _____

What other payments am I already carrying? _____

Is this helping me build, or helping me avoid a harder decision? _____

BEFORE YOU SIGN SUMMARY

The decision is: _____

The true cost is: _____

The monthly payment or obligation is: _____

The hidden or extra costs are: _____

The assumptions that have to be true are: _____

The pressure this could add is: _____

The flexibility this could remove is: _____

The part of my foundation most affected is: _____

What does this require from my future self? _____

My next step before signing is: _____

PART FIVE: MARGIN, LEAKS, AND PRESSURE

Margin is the space between what comes in and what must go out. It lets a hard week stay a hard week instead of becoming a financial setback.

Margin does not always come from one dramatic change. Sometimes it comes from seeing the structure clearly: a payment reduced, a leak closed, a habit changed, a second income doorway opened, or a savings transfer protected.

GOAL

This section is not about cutting everything until life feels empty. It is about finding the places where money is leaving your life without making your life stronger.

MONTHLY MARGIN

Monthly take-home income: \$ _____

Other regular monthly income: \$ _____

Total monthly income: \$ _____

Fixed obligations: \$ _____

Minimum debt payments: \$ _____

Average variable spending: \$ _____

Savings and investing: \$ _____

Other monthly spending: \$ _____

Estimated monthly margin: \$ _____

MARGIN CHECK

Does this margin usually stay available, or does it disappear before the month ends?

If it disappears, where does it usually go? _____

Is my margin real, or only real on paper? _____

PRESSURE POINTS

Pressure Point 1

The pressure point is: _____

☐ Income	☐ Saving	☐ Debt	☐ Vision
☐ Spending	☐ Investing	☐ Protection	

How it shows up in my life: _____

What would improve if this pressure eased: _____

Pressure Point 2

The pressure point is: _____

☐ Income	☐ Saving	☐ Debt	☐ Vision
☐ Spending	☐ Investing	☐ Protection	

How it shows up in my life: _____

What would improve if this pressure eased: _____

Pressure Point 3

The pressure point is: _____

☐ Income	☐ Saving	☐ Debt	☐ Vision
☐ Spending	☐ Investing	☐ Protection	

How it shows up in my life: _____

What would improve if this pressure eased: _____

MONEY LEAKS REVIEW

A money leak is not always a huge expense. Sometimes it is a small habit, convenience cost, subscription, stress response, or status expense that quietly drains margin.

Expense or Habit	Category	Monthly Est.	What It Is Doing	Choice
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove
_____	_____	\$ _____	_____	Keep / Reduce / Replace / Remove

PICK ONE LEAK

The leak I will address first is: _____

This leak costs about: \$ _____

This leak matters because: _____

This leak is mostly connected to:

☐ Habit

☐ Convenience

☐ Pressure

☐ Status

☐ Avoidance

☐ Lack of planning

☐ Other

Instead of this leak, I will: _____

The boundary I need to set is: _____

Estimated monthly amount freed up: _____

I will redirect this money to: _____

Date I will start: _____

NORMAL VS. INTENTIONAL

Normal is powerful because it rarely asks permission. Ordinary does not always mean healthy. Intentional means chosen with clear eyes.

One thing I have accepted as normal is: _____

I probably accepted it because: _____

This creates pressure by: _____

An intentional version would look like: _____

The first small change I can make is: _____

The person I am becoming through this decision is: _____

WHAT MOVE CREATES BREATHING ROOM?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Reduce or eliminate a payment | ☐ Cancel or renegotiate a bill |
| ☐ Build first emergency savings | ☐ Delay a major decision |
| ☐ Stop adding to one debt | ☐ Review retirement contributions |
| ☐ Pay extra on one debt | ☐ Create the Protection Folder |
| ☐ Reduce one money leak | ☐ Have an honest money conversation |
| ☐ Increase income through one more doorway | ☐ Use a website calculator before deciding |
| ☐ Sell something and use the money intentionally | ☐ Other |

The move most likely to create breathing room right now is: _____

I am choosing this move because: _____

The first step is: _____

I will take that step by: _____

PART SIX: YOUR NEXT RIGHT MOVE

By this point, you have looked at a lot. Now the temptation may be to make a long list of everything you should fix. Do not do that yet.

CORE IDEA

Do not choose the move that sounds most impressive. Choose the move that creates the most breathing room or removes the most pressure.

The biggest pressure point I see right now is: _____

This pressure shows up most often as: _____

The building block most affected is: _____

The move I am choosing first is: _____

I am choosing this move because: _____

This move should create breathing room by: _____

MAKE IT SPECIFIC

The first step is: _____

I will complete this step by this date: _____

The amount of money involved, if any, is: _____

The account, bill, debt, habit, document, or decision involved is: _____

The person I may need to contact is: _____

What could get in the way: _____

How I will make this easier: _____

30-DAY PLAN

The first 30 days are about clarity and one useful action. Build momentum, not pressure.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Finish the Three-Month Checkup | ☐ Use Car Payment Opportunity Cost Calculator |
| ☐ List all debts in one place | ☐ Review retirement contribution |
| ☐ Open or restart emergency savings | ☐ Log into a retirement account |
| ☐ Set up an automatic savings transfer | ☐ Begin my Protection Folder |
| ☐ Cancel or reduce one money leak | ☐ Review beneficiaries |
| ☐ Stop adding to one credit card balance | ☐ Have one honest money conversation |
| ☐ Make one extra debt payment | ☐ Delay a major decision until I have more clarity |
| ☐ Use My Freedom Date Calculator | |

My 30-day move: _____

Why this move matters: _____

First step: _____

How I will know it is done: _____

60-DAY PLAN

The next 30 days are about strengthening one weak block. This does not mean fixing it perfectly. It means making it stronger than it was.

The block I am strengthening is:

☐ Income ☐ Saving ☐ Debt ☐ Vision
☐ Spending ☐ Investing ☐ Protection

This block needs attention because: _____

A stronger version of this block would look like: _____

The habit, payment, account, document, or decision I am working on is:

The specific action I will take is: _____

The structure I will put in place is: _____

My 60-day checkpoint: _____

90-DAY PLAN

The 90-day point is not the finish line. It is a checkup.

What changed over the last 90 days? _____

What feels calmer? _____

What still feels tight? _____

What got clearer? _____

What surprised me? _____

What pressure reduced? _____

What pressure remains? _____

My next right move now is: _____

DASHBOARD CHECK-IN

If you use AWealthyFoundation.com, compare this plan with your Foundation Report or Dashboard. The website can help you track progress, but this workbook is enough to continue.

YOUR FOUNDATION SUMMARY

Date: _____

My Foundation Score: _____

My strongest building block: _____

My weakest building block: _____

The block creating the most pressure: _____

My biggest pressure point: _____

My biggest money leak: _____

My first breathing room savings target: _____

My biggest protection gap: _____

What I am building: _____

The next right move I am choosing now: _____

PART SEVEN: KEEP BUILDING

Building a stronger foundation is not something you finish once and never return to. Your income, expenses, debts, family, goals, pressure points, and next right move may change.

That does not mean you are starting over. It means you are still building.

Today's date: _____

I want to review this workbook again on: _____

I want to retake my Foundation Score on: _____

The section I should revisit first is:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Foundation Score | ☐ Debt |
| ☐ Three-Month Checkup | ☐ Protection |
| ☐ Income | ☐ Vision |
| ☐ Spending | ☐ Major Decisions |
| ☐ Saving | ☐ Margin and Money Leaks |
| ☐ Investing | ☐ 30/60/90-Day Plan |

CONTINUE BUILDING AT AWEALTHYFOUNDATION.COM

This workbook can stand on its own. But if you want a more interactive companion, visit AWealthyFoundation.com.

Resource	Use it for
Free Foundation Score	Take or retake the assessment and see where your foundation is strongest.
Dashboard	Review your building blocks and track progress.
Foundation Report	Understand pressure points and next steps in more detail.
My Freedom Date Calculator	See how extra payments can move your debt-free date closer.
Car Payment Opportunity Cost Calculator	Review the long-term impact of a vehicle payment.
The Foundation Report newsletter	Receive ongoing encouragement and practical ideas.
Updated workbook downloads	Download a fresh copy whenever you want to work through it again.

WHEN TO ASK FOR HELP

Asking for help is not failure. Sometimes the next right move is bringing the right person into the conversation.

I may need help with:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Taxes | ☐ Debt payoff options |
| ☐ Insurance | ☐ Credit counseling |
| ☐ Estate planning | ☐ Home purchase decision |
| ☐ Wills or trusts | ☐ Car purchase decision |
| ☐ Retirement accounts | ☐ College decision |
| ☐ Investment choices | ☐ Benefits through work |
| ☐ Student loans | ☐ Budgeting or accountability |

Possible people to contact:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ HR or benefits department | ☐ Financial planner |
| ☐ Retirement plan provider | ☐ Student loan servicer |
| ☐ Insurance agent | ☐ Nonprofit credit counselor |
| ☐ Tax professional | ☐ Mortgage professional |
| ☐ Estate attorney | ☐ Trusted family member or mentor |

The area where I may need help first is: _____

A NOTE TO MY FUTURE SELF

Before you close this workbook, write a note to your future self. Write what you may need to remember when pressure returns.

When money feels tight, I want to remember: _____

When I feel behind, I want to remember: _____

When I am tempted to make a decision too quickly, I want to remember:

When normal starts pulling me back, I want to remember: _____

When progress feels slow, I want to remember: _____

When I need to choose the next right move, I want to ask: _____

FINAL FOUNDATION STATEMENT

I am building a financial life that is: _____

I want money to help me: _____

I want to stop letting money: _____

The pressure I am working to reduce is: _____

The building block I am strengthening first is: _____

The next right move I am choosing is: _____

If I keep building, one year from now I hope: _____

FINAL ENCOURAGEMENT

You do not have to fix every mistake at once. Start where you are. Look honestly. Find the pressure. Strengthen one block. Choose the next right move. Then keep building.

See clearly. Find the pressure. Choose the next right move. Keep building.